

All-in-one Mobile Charger

An energy efficient standard charger for mobiles will be launched in the market, said International Telecommunication Union (ITU), as demand for mobiles keep increasing

Indian PC sales improving

Sales of personal computers in India increased by 33 percent in the first quarter this year

Wi-Fi test

Netgear	SMC Networks
JWNR2000	SMCWBR14S-N3
2,900	2,950
47.66	65.30
11.45	14.11
36.21	51.19
N/Y/Y/Y/N	N/Y/Y/Y/N
Ethernet	Ethernet
4	4
0	1
Y/Y/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y/Y
N/Y	Y/Y
Y	Y
N	Y
N	N
N	N
WPA / WPA2 / WEP	WEP / WPA / WPA2
SPI / NAT	NAT / SPI
N	N
N	Y
Y	Y
Y	Y
N/Y	N/Y
Y/Y	Y/Y
6	6
6	6
6	6.5
6.5	6
65	66
2.78	2.38
1.44	1.84
50	51
2.72	2.23
1.36	1.78
18	30
0.12	0.71
0.25	0.55
1.77	2.63
1.27	2.31
0.54	0.78
5 / 3 / 2	8 / 8 / 3
8 / 6 / 2	8 / 8 / 8

the rest struggled to get past the 1Mbps mark. Real world tests weren't as promising.

Belkin has a new strategy and positioning of products to make things simple for the customer. We don't know how well that will work out for customers, but we know that their latest N300 Surf router works flawlessly for media streaming. File transfers in the zone 1 and zone 2 are average but speeds don't deteriorate as much as the rest. Speeds of between 1.5 to 1.9 MB/s can be expected

if you're transferring from a floor above or under the router.

Rs. 5,001 to Rs. 8,000

In this category, we received all 802.11n routers and also a couple of ADSL routers. USB ports become more and more common.

Features

While USB ports were a common feature, the ability to connect a 3G USB datacard was something new and unseen. SMC products such as the SMCWBR11S-3GN and SMCWBR14-3GN had this feature. No longer do you have to depend on a wired



D-Link DIR-615

ADSL or cable connection. This feature is particularly useful for those who travel very often and need to carry your wireless network with you.

While most of the Linksys routers look more or less the same, the Linksys WRT610N comes with an attractive colour set. The product we received came with a sparkling blue border surrounding the black glossy body. The WRT610N has more features when it comes to quality of service options. The interface is not as straight forward as the ASUS routers that we've tested but in the QoS settings, it lets you choose from prominent applications and

games. The traffic going to and from these applications can be granted higher priority for better performance. The USB storage feature allows you run a FTP server using a USB complaint storage device. There is quite some heating noticeable at the base of the router.

The same old Linksys design continues with the Linksys WAG160N. It comes with an ADSL component built into it. Fortunately, there's an option to use one of the other LAN ports as a WAN connection if you choose to move to an ISP that uses Ethernet to distribute connections. Logs can be customised as well. Logs can be generated on DDOS attacks and even mailed to a particular email address. This is a great security feature.

The Netgear WNR3500's front panel has indicators for the different connections and ports. Instead of small lights, there are larger numbers behind which the LEDs are placed. Identifying connections becomes simpler. The router heats up a bit after an hour or two of use. Bundled packages with all the routers were standard although we quite like the excellent quality of bundled cables with the WNR3500. The interface is somewhat bland. There is a pane on the left using frames to separate the two panes. Help is provided on the rightmost pane in somewhat decent detail.

Performance

There is a clear performance improvement with 802.11n routers and that's something that's clear when you access in the router from the same room or from the adjoining room. When you get any further, speeds come plummeting. Of all the routers in the category, close to half the products were left struggling to cross 0.5Mbps speeds. Linksys WAG160N, WRT610N and Net-

gear's WNR3500 were the superior products of the lot. In HD video streaming, the Linksys WRT610N was the only one that was able to stream content without any any loss in performance.

Rs. 8,001 to Rs. 11,000

Routers in this price range are meant for enthusiasts. Performance is key but at the same time, good designs, features for data sharing and security are equally important

Features

The Linksys WRT320N is a dual-Band 802.11n Gigabit router which like most of Linksys' new routers lack a visible antenna. The WPS feature is very prominent - there is a button on the router as well as a clear menu in the router firmware. Unlike the cheaper WRT54GH and also similarly priced models from other makes, WPA2 Enterprise encryption makes an appearance here. The firmware seems more refined, has more features for security are promi-



SMC SMCWBR11S-3GN

nent. Wireless isolation is a clear feature as well which isn't found on all routers. The QoS feature is also detailed. It allows you to prioritize applications for improved upload speeds. The setting allows you to select a kind of application and also, the priority for it. This is obviously a router for more serious users in SoHo